Bridging the Industry-Academe Gap: Leveraging Data Analytics for Organizational Agility

The emergence of technology is something that we cannot separate ourselves with it. There is a need to educate ourselves about these trends and at the same time invest in improving company's IT resources. These developments lead to a wide range of data availability that must be exploited to be able to maximize the use of this available information through optimizing marketing mix decisions and personalization using analytics that can enhance and improve precision in marketing decisions. However, the industry and the academe are challenged with these hurdles: the use of such data in the context of consumer's privacy and data security in maximizing data availability and the growing demand of marketing analyst which the academe has to prepare to align the academic requirements with the current needs of the industry.

Technology has a tremendous impact on the way consumers interact with companies. Customers have both traditional and modern channels to acquire information from companies, including direct mail, television, Internet, e-mail, mobile phones, and social media. People want choices and they want information fast. (Corrigan et. al., 2014). These trends must be responded the way consumers wanted and the need for the industries agility to adapt and the need for the academy to assist this need by aligning the industry and organizations facilities, operations and structure to achieve organizational performance.

According to Chapter 2 (2011) entitled: The Philippine Labor Market Performance: A Decade in Review-The Philippine Labor and Employment Plan 2011-2016 say that "Global economic upturn in recent years not matched by expansion in employment. Employment growth in "boom and bust pattern" lags behind GDP growth, over the same period, employment grew but at a slower pace on the average, at 2.9% annually. DOLE (2012) To be able to address this concern, the plan consisting government agencies like Department of Labor and Employment, Commission on Higher Education (CHED) and Department of Education (DepEd) and the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA) have drawn up four convergent programs to address the jobs mismatch issue namely: Philippine Qualifications Framework -evaluating the needs of industry that must be addressed by the academe; career guidance advocacy -a guide to enhance understanding and opportunities for career growth; and optimizing the utilization of the Phil-Jobnet - an automated job and applicant matching system which aims to fast-track jobseekers search for jobs and employers search for manpower. These endeavors are taking a step forward towards addressing the need and implementation of big data analytics.

The educational setting in the Philippines in terms of awareness in this data driven environments, lags behind in terms of education and appreciation on the relevance of marketing analytics, moreover, not all schools have the facility to teach the subject and the most challenging here is, not all teachers in the academe has the experience, understanding and appreciation of marketing analytics. According to Senator Pimentel (2017) “The key is focusing on teachers, because "compelling evidence from international experience indicates that teachers who possess strong content knowledge are the main determining factor behind high-performing students. Thus, the need for trained and experts in this field is necessary to fully deliver and transfer knowledge necessary in preparing the future Filipino marketing analysts.

In developing a policy proposal for the Philippine academia to address these issues better, the academe and government must identify the use of marketing analytics that will guide them in designing the new curriculum that incorporates Descriptive analytics (explains what happened) Diagnostic analytics (explains why it happened) Predictive analytics (forecasts what might happen) Prescriptive Analytics (recommends an action based on forecast) that will be integrated in the present business and management curriculum, according to Harvard Business Review, there are 11 business activities that influence the use of marketing analytics: Customer Acquistion – 36.6%, Marketing Mix – 31.5%, Customer Retention and Social Media - 30.7% and Segmentation and Promotion Strategy 29.2%. (See Appendix A -How Companies are Using Marketing Analytics). This will help the academe determine a functional and an effective curriculum that will produce the demand of marketing analysts in the industry. First, business and management curriculum across universities must reinforce and enhance the research capabilities in its curriculum, this is necessary for the students to conduct research and study the trends in the Filipino market and to be able to share data across other schools in a form of gathering or symposia where in schools with business and management offerings must participate and present their research to the participating students to be able to exchange information. Each school must have different industries to present and the universities involved must discuss these things to be able to create a diversified learning environment for the students. “The Multi-channel learning system is a deliberate, planned configuration to create the sync and synergize the power of various media to achieve optimal learning. This examines instructional design for the classroom, for self- instructional materials, media, experiential learning—and Multi Channeling Learning Systems.” (Mukhopadhyay, M., & Parhar, M. 2001) Second, contextualized topics must be supplemented with an integrative experience and simulation using software’s and social media platforms. This will help students gain

insights in an integrative real-world marketing experience with the essentials of selecting a target market then creating, publishing, and promoting an article that will incorporate new product development, social media, analytics, and campaign management. (Cowley, 2017) The practicum creates a learning environment and a social media virtual laboratory for their testing of creative ideas. In the process of building, engaging, and serving a community, educators may adapt media types, time and number of tasks, scope of responsibility, and roles of participants, to achieve the learning objectives of different courses in a marketing curriculum. (Atwong, 2015) Lastly, as students explore the capabilities on a wide range of data availability, it is also necessary that the curriculum must also integrate and study about Security and Privacy of consumers concerning the issue on data mining implications, enhancement and development of policies to study the scope and limitations of marketing analysts in predicting future needs and in selecting a personalized promotional strategy for every consumer. “Although many organizations now post online privacy policies, these organizations must realize that simply posting a privacy policy on their web site does not guarantee compliance with existing legislation.” (Antón, et.al 2007) This is very important to be able to give insights on how to gain consumer confidence and to identify what privacy path that the company needs to do in the data they gathered either transparent or with concealment will depend on the values that the company needs to build in its customers. On the other hand, this step will help businesses identify the need to revisit the opportunities and challenges of data mining and select strategies that build accurate models but still preserve privacy at the individual level of its consumers. (Corrigan, et.al, 2014)

The area of digital marketing is a difficult one for course development. Not only is it a relatively new topic area—having become popular after many marketing faculty completed their academic training—it is a constantly changing one wherein “innovative” tools are continuously being replaced within the industry. (Staton, 2015) This is not the only concern of the industry, it is a collaborative effort of the government to design policies relating to analytics and the academe who will prepare skills of the students that will put the country in its competitive advantage in preparing the marketing analysts of the future.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A - How Companies are Using Marketing Analytics

APPENDIX B – MULTI- CHANNEL LEARNING SYSTEMS

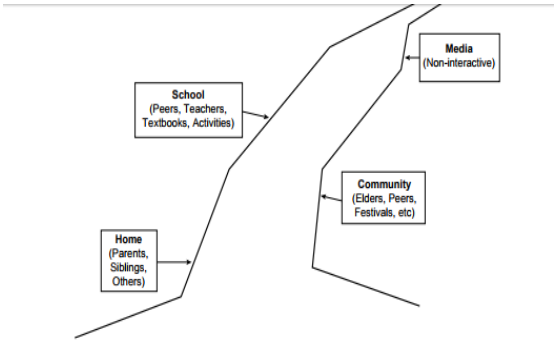

Figure 1: Road-map to learning

References:

Antón, A. I., Bertino, E., Ninghui, L., & Ting, Y. (2007). A Roadmap For Comprehensive Online Privacy Policy Management. Communications Of The ACM, 50(7), 109-116. Doi:10.1145/1272516.1272522

Atwong, C. T. (2015). A Social Media Practicum: An Action-Learning Approach to Social Media Marketing and Analytics. Marketing Education Review, 25(1), 27-31.

Corrigan, H. B., Craciun, G., & Powell, A. M. (2014). How Does Target Know So Much About Its Customers? Utilizing Customer Analytics to Make Marketing Decisions. Marketing Education Review, 24(2), 159-166. doi:10.2753/MER1052-8008240206

Cowley, S. W. (2017). The BuzzFeed Marketing Challenge: An Integrative Social Media Experience. Marketing Education Review, 27(2), 109-114.

Mukhopadhyay, M., & Parhar, M. (2001). Instructional design in multi-channel learning system. British Journal pf Educational Technology, 32(5), 543.

Staton, M. G. (2016). Improving Student Job Placement and Assessment through the Use of Digital Marketing Certification Programs. Marketing Education Review, 26(1), 20-24.

ONLINE REFERENCES:

Quantifying the Impact of Marketing Analytics. Harvard Business Review (2015).

Retrieved from: https://hbr.org/2015/11/quantifying-the-impact-of-marketing-analytics

Retrieved from: https://www.dole.gov.ph/fndr/bong/files/PLEP-26%20April%20version.pdf

DOLE, Partner Agencies Identify Four Convergent Programs to Address Jobs Mismatch (2012).

Retrieved from: https://www.dole.gov.ph/good_news/view/65

Philippine Star: Pimentel Urges DepEd to teach computer programming to graders (2017). Retrieved

from: https://news.mb.com.ph/2017/12/06/pimentel-urges-deped-to-teach-computer-programming-to-graders/